

National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey

August 2021-August 2023 Data Documentation, Codebook, and Frequencies

Physical Activity (PAQ_L)

Data File: PAQ_L.xpt

First Published: September 2024

Last Revised: NA

Component Description

The adult section of the Physical Activity questionnaire (variable name prefix PAQ) provides respondent-level interview data on physical activities.

Eligible Sample

Participants aged 18 years and over were eligible.

Interview Setting and Mode of Administration

These questions were asked, in the home or by telephone, by trained interviewers using the Computer-Assisted Personal Interview (CAPI) system. A proxy provided information for survey participants who could not answer the questions themselves. The respondent selected the language of interview (English or Spanish) or requested that an interpreter be used.

The questionnaire and information about the interview procedures are available on the [NHANES website](#).

Quality Assurance & Quality Control

The CAPI system is programmed with built-in consistency checks to reduce data entry errors. CAPI also uses online help screens to assist interviewers in defining key terms used in the questionnaire.

After collection, interview data were reviewed by the NHANES field office staff for accuracy and completeness of selected items. The interviewers were required to audio-record interviews and the recorded interviews were reviewed by NCHS staff and interviewer supervisors.

Data Processing and Editing

The data were reviewed for completeness, consistency, and illogical values. Data for respondents who reported an average of 24 hours or more per day of activity was set to missing. Users should carefully inspect the data for other values they may consider too high.

Analytic Notes

Since the question on sedentary behavior (PAD680) was first asked in 2007, several probes have been used with it. For example, midway through the 2011-12 survey cycle, a probe was added querying times less than 8 hours. These probes may partially explain any observed differences in sedentary behavior between survey cycles.

Since the questionnaire was asked during the household interview, the interview sample weights should be used in the analysis. However, if the data is joined with data from the Mobile Exam Center (MEC), the MEC sample weights should be used. Please refer to the [Analytic Guidelines](#) and the [NHANES Tutorials](#) for the use of sample weights and other analytic issues.

Codebook and Frequencies

SEQN - Respondent sequence number

Variable Name:	SEQN
SAS Label:	Respondent sequence number
English Text:	Respondent sequence number.
Target:	Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

PAD790Q - Frequency of moderate LTPA

Variable Name: PAD790Q

SAS Label: Frequency of moderate LTPA

English Text: The next questions are about physical activities such as exercise, sports, or physically active hobbies that you may do in your leisure time. We are interested in two types of physical activity: moderate and vigorous-intensity. Moderate-intensity activities cause moderate increases in breathing or heart rate whereas vigorous-intensity activities cause large increases in breathing or heart rate. How often {do you/does SP} do moderate-intensity leisure-time physical activities?

English Instructions: ENTER NUMBER OF TIMES (PER DAY, WEEK, MONTH, OR YEAR) CAPI INSTRUCTIONS: SOFT EDIT: > 4 PER DAY, > 28 PER WEEK, >31 PER MONTH, OR > 365 PER YEAR. ERROR MESSAGE: PLEASE VERIFY THE QUANTITY AND UNIT.

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0 to 180	Range of Values	8086	8086	
7777	Refused	10	8096	PAD810Q
9999	Don't know	39	8135	PAD810Q
.	Missing	18	8153	

PAD790U - Moderate LTPA unit (day/week/month/year)

Variable Name: PAD790U

SAS Label: Moderate LTPA unit (day/week/month/year)

English Text: The next questions are about physical activities such as exercise, sports, or physically active hobbies that you may do in your leisure time. We are interested in two types of physical activity: moderate and vigorous-intensity. Moderate-intensity activities cause moderate increases in breathing or heart rate whereas vigorous-intensity activities cause large increases in breathing or heart rate. How often {do you/does SP} do moderate-intensity leisure-time physical activities?

English Instructions: ENTER UNIT CAPI INSTRUCTIONS: SOFT EDIT: > 4 PER DAY, > 28 PER WEEK, >31 PER MONTH, OR > 365 PER YEAR. ERROR MESSAGE: PLEASE VERIFY THE QUANTITY AND UNIT.

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
D	Day	985	985	
M	Month	472	1457	
W	Week	4851	6308	
Y	Year	82	6390	
< blank >	Missing	1763	8153	

PAD800 - Minutes moderate LTPA

Variable Name: PAD800

SAS Label: Minutes moderate LTPA

English Text: About how long {do you/does SP} do these moderate leisure-time physical activities each time?

English Instructions: ENTER NUMBER OF MINUTES OR HOURS PROBE IF NEEDED:
Moderate-intensity activities cause moderate increases in breathing or heart rate. CAPI INSTRUCTIONS: SOFT EDIT: > 120 MINUTES OR 2 HOURS. ERROR MESSAGE: YOU HAVE RECORDED THAT THE SP SPENDS MORE THAN 120 MINUTES OR 2 HOURS EACH TIME DOING MODERATE-INTENSITY LEISURE-TIME ACTIVITIES. PLEASE CONFIRM WITH SP THAT OVER 120 MINUTES OR 2 HOURS IS CORRECT. HARD EDIT: 0 MINUTES OR HOURS HARD EDIT: 24 HOURS OR MORE. ERROR MESSAGE: THE TIME SHOULD BE LESS THAN 24 HOURS.

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 720	Range of Values	6371	6371	
7777	Refused	0	6371	
9999	Don't know	19	6390	
.	Missing	1763	8153	

PAD810Q - Frequency of vigorous LTPA

Variable Name: PAD810Q

SAS Label: Frequency of vigorous LTPA

English Text: How often {do you/does SP} do vigorous-intensity leisure-time physical activities?

English Instructions: ENTER NUMBER OF TIMES (PER DAY, WEEK, MONTH, OR YEAR) CAPI
INSTRUCTIONS: SOFT EDIT: > 4 PER DAY, > 28 PER WEEK, >31 PER MONTH, OR > 365 PER YEAR . ERROR MESSAGE: PLEASE VERIFY THE QUANTITY AND UNIT.

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0 to 200	Range of Values	8099	8099	
7777	Refused	4	8103	PAD680
9999	Don't know	36	8139	PAD680
.	Missing	14	8153	

PAD810U - Vigorous LTPA unit (day/week/month/year)

Variable Name: PAD810U

SAS Label: Vigorous LTPA unit (day/week/month/year)

English Text: How often {do you/does SP} do vigorous-intensity leisure-time physical activities?

English Instructions: ENTER UNIT CAPI INSTRUCTIONS: SOFT EDIT: > 4 PER DAY, > 28 PER WEEK, >31 PER MONTH, OR > 365 PER YEAR . ERROR MESSAGE: PLEASE VERIFY THE QUANTITY AND UNIT.

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
D	Day	235	235	
M	Month	711	946	
W	Week	2590	3536	
Y	Year	150	3686	
< blank >	Missing	4467	8153	

PAD820 - Minutes vigorous LTPA

Variable Name: PAD820

SAS Label: Minutes vigorous LTPA

English Text: About how long {do you/does SP} do these vigorous leisure-time physical activities each time?

English Instructions: ENTER NUMBER OF MINUTES OR HOURS PROBE IF NEEDED:
Vigorous-intensity activities cause large increases in breathing or heart rate. CAPI INSTRUCTIONS: SOFT EDIT: > 120 MINUTES OR 2 HOURS. ERROR MESSAGE: YOU HAVE RECORDED THAT THE SP SPENDS MORE THAN 120 MINUTES OR 2 HOURS EACH TIME DOING VIGOROUS-INTENSITY LEISURE-TIME ACTIVITIES. PLEASE CONFIRM WITH SP THAT OVER 120 MINUTES OR 2 HOURS IS CORRECT. HARD EDIT: 0 MINUTES OR HOURS. HARD EDIT: 24 HOURS OR MORE. ERROR MESSAGE: THE TIME SHOULD BE LESS THAN 24 HOURS.

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
1 to 900	Range of Values	3673	3673	
7777	Refused	1	3674	
9999	Don't know	13	3687	
.	Missing	4466	8153	

PAD680 - Minutes sedentary activity

Variable Name: PAD680

SAS Label: Minutes sedentary activity

English Text: The following question is about sitting at school, at home, getting to and from places, or with friends including time spent sitting at a desk, traveling in a car or bus, reading, playing cards, watching television, or using a computer. Do not include time spent sleeping. How much time {do you/does SP} usually spend sitting on a typical day?

English Instructions: ENTER NUMBER OF MINUTES OR HOURS. SOFT EDIT: 18 HOURS OR MORE. ERROR MESSAGE: PLEASE VERIFY TIMES OF 18 HOURS OR MORE. HARD EDIT: 24 HOURS OR MORE. ERROR MESSAGE: THE TIME SHOULD BE LESS THAN 24 HOURS.

Target: Both males and females 18 YEARS - 150 YEARS

Code or Value	Value Description	Count	Cumulative	Skip to Item
0 to 1380	Range of Values	8065	8065	
7777	Refused	6	8071	
9999	Don't know	67	8138	
.	Missing	15	8153	